Lesson 21: Project Part 1: Interview; Vocabulary Review

English Stage 1 (B1) · Unit 2: Getting to Know You

Adapted from Speaking, Listening and Pronunciation Projects for ELLs - Intermediate Level by Brittany Zemlick, Grossmont College (CC BY 4.0): Unit Project Part 1- Interview; and from Getting to Know You - An Intermediate Integrated-Skills Module for English Learners by Sara Ferguson, Grossmont College (CC BY-NC-SA): Vocabulary Review: Getting to Know You.

In this lesson

You will plan, practice and record an interview in English. Your AI tutor plays a person with a job and a life story, and you ask the questions. You will also review the unit's words about college, careers and education.

Learning goals

After this lesson you should be able to:

- Write at least 5 yes/no questions and 5 wh- questions about a person's job, hobbies, family and values.
- Ask questions with the correct intonation: rising for yes/no questions, falling for wh- questions.
- Mark rising and falling intonation on a written list of questions.
- Use words about college and careers, such as major, semester, scholarship and mentor.
- Understand the idioms "not by a long shot", "don't mess with", "lead through example" and "on board".

Key language

Word or phrase	Meaning in simple English	Example
interview (n, v)	a meeting where one person asks another person questions	Make a video of yourself interviewing someone you know.
interviewee	the person who answers the questions	The student looks at the interviewee often.
yes/no question	a question with the answer "yes" or "no"; it starts with do, are, is, can...	Do you have a car?
wh- question	a question that starts with what, where, when, why, who or how	Where did you grow up?
values	the things that are most important to a person	Ask about the person's values.
intern (n, v)	a person who works for little or no pay to learn a job; to work in this way	When he was in college, he interned at an architectural company.

Word or phrase	Meaning in simple English	Example
(not) by a long shot	(usually negative) not at all; a strong "no"	Did you pass the final exam? Not by a long shot.
don't mess with	(informal) don't make this person angry; don't cause trouble with this thing	Don't mess with the dog next door. It might bite you.
lead through example	act in a way that shows others how to act	It's important that parents lead through example.
on board	on a team; working here or with us	Now that Mike is on board at this company, our work will be much easier.
multi- / un-, in-, im-, non-	prefixes: multi- means "many"; un-, in-, im- and non- mean "not"	multilingual, undeclared, impossible, non-verbal

Rules and explanations

The interview project

- Write at least **5 yes/no questions** and **5 wh- questions**. You can use questions from this unit.
- Ask about the person's **job**, **hobbies**, **family** and **values** (what is most important to the person).
- Ask at least **2 questions that are not** in the example video (Andy's interview).
- Put your questions in order. Practice them until you can ask them without reading.
- After the interview, write a list of at least 10 questions you asked. Mark each one "rise" (↗) or "fall" (↘).

Intonation in questions

- **Yes/no questions** rise at the end: Do you eat meat? (↗)
- **Wh- questions** fall at the end: Why are you vegan? (↘)

What makes a good interview (from the book's checklist)

- Speak loudly and confidently. Look at the interviewee often. Use your notes very little.
- Pronounce vowels and consonants clearly, link consonants to vowels, and use the correct intonation for every question.

Vocabulary points

- Some words are **both nouns and verbs** with the same meaning: intern, volunteer, design, mentor, challenge. As verbs, they need the correct tense and -s ending (he interned).
- Some verbs **need an object** (somebody or something after them): inspire (somebody), motivate (somebody), pursue (somebody or something), develop (something).

> **Note for Arabic speakers** - In Arabic, a yes/no question can keep the word order of a statement. A normal English question puts a helping verb first: "Do you have a car?" (not "You

> have a car?"), "Are you a vegan?" - Wh- questions need the helping verb too: "Where do you live?" (not "Where you live?")

Practice

1. Plan your questions. Write at least 5 yes/no and 5 wh- questions to ask a person about their life (job, hobbies, family, values). At least 2 must not be in the example video. Put them in order and mark each one ↗ or ↘.

2. Practice aloud. Record yourself reading your questions and listen. Does your voice go up at the end of yes/no questions and down at the end of wh- questions?

3. The interview. In Live conversation, ask your tutor to play a person with a job and a life story (see "Speak with your tutor"). Ask your questions one at a time and listen. Ask a new question if an answer is interesting. Record yourself on your phone (video if you can). Take notes: name, where the person is from, job, daily tasks, free time, family, values. **Keep your notes for Lesson 25.**

4. Check your interview. Listen to your recording. Did you ask about the job, hobbies, family and values? Did you ask 5 yes/no and 5 wh- questions? Did you speak clearly, without reading every question? Was your intonation correct? Write your list of 10 questions with ↗ or ↘. Then write one thing you did well and one thing to do better.

5. College and university. a) Write the four years of high school or college: Freshman, _____, _____, _____. b) Write four degrees: _____, _____, _____, Doctoral degree. c) Match the words (major, graduation, dormitory, specialize, semester, scholarship) with the examples:

1. A small room or apartment where students sleep
2. Spring, Summer, or Fall in college
3. Free money for students to attend school
4. Child development, biology, psychology, engineering
5. To study a specific topic deeply and in detail
6. A special celebration of the completion of a course of study

d) Fill in the blanks with: program, graduate, undergraduate, declare a major.

1. A counselor can help you _____.
2. Students who are studying for an associate's degree or bachelor's degree are called _____ students.
3. Students who are studying for a degree after their bachelor's are called _____ students.
4. A _____ is a plan of action to achieve a goal.

6. Nouns and verbs. Use volunteer, design, mentor or challenge. Check the tense.

1. When Jennifer gets her degree, she wants to _____ buildings and parks.
2. The _____ for the Empire State Building is a beautiful art deco style.
3. When I was a student, I _____ in the food pantry. I worked for free because I wanted to help others.

4. Razia is a _____ at the symphony. She hands out programs and sells tickets, but doesn't receive any pay.
5. It is a _____ to learn English. It takes a lot of time, energy, and hard work!
6. Our instructor always _____ us to learn more vocabulary. After we learn 5 words, she says, "Try one more!"
7. More experienced students _____ new students by showing them the campus.
8. When you start a new job, it's so valuable to have a _____.

7. Verbs with an object. Use inspire, motivate, pursue, develop. a) Two words mean "to cause someone to want to do something": _____ and _____. One word means "to follow": _____. One word means "to build something or cause it to grow": _____. b) Fill in the blanks:

1. Her eighth grade teacher _____ her to study physics because he made it so interesting. (two answers)
2. After college, he decided to _____ a career in photography.
3. In geography class, she _____ an interest in geomatics.

8. My dream career. Use adventure, travel, goal, employer, skills, in high demand.

1. I prefer a career where my _____ is a small business, not a large organization.
2. I want my job to be an _____.
3. I also like to _____, whether it's by plane or by car.
4. My _____ is to earn a degree from a good university in a field that is _____.
5. I will learn all of the _____ that I need to pursue a satisfying career.

9. Match the words with the definitions. Words: resource, recipient, journey, public service, professional, personal, opportunity, valuable, task.

1. A person who receives something
2. Chance; suitable time
3. A job that helps everyone in the community; sometimes a job in the government
4. The act of traveling
5. A small job
6. A place or thing that is useful
7. Private; affecting just one person
8. Affecting the career or job
9. Very helpful or important, or worth a lot of money

Speak with your tutor

- "Please play a person with a job and an interesting life. Choose your name, job, family, hobbies and values. I will interview you. Answer in two to four sentences, and do not ask me questions."
- "After my interview, tell me which questions had a grammar mistake or the wrong intonation. Then give me three follow-up questions I could ask."

- "Now interview me about my job, hobbies, family and values. Ask one question at a time and correct my answers."
- "Ask me about my education. Use the words major, semester, degree, scholarship and mentor in your questions."
- "Give me one sentence with a blank for each idiom: by a long shot, don't mess with, lead through example, on board. I will fill in the blanks."

Read aloud

- What's your name? (↘)
- Where did you grow up? (↘)
- What do you like to do in your free time? (↘)
- Why is your job important to you? (↘)
- Do you have a car? (↗)
- Are you a morning person? (↗)
- Do you eat meat? (↗)
- Are you a vegan? (↗)
- se·MES·ter, SCHOL·ar·ship, vol·un·TEER
- op·por·TU·ni·ty

Watch online

- The example interview (Andy's job); watch it for ideas, but you do not need to ask the same questions: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Wa0582oOYgY

Answer key

1-2. (example answer)

- Yes/no: Do you like your job? (↗) Are you married? (↗) Do you have any children? (↗) Do you play any sports? (↗) Is your family important to you? (↗)
- Wh-: What do you do? (↘) Where do you work? (↘) What do you do in your free time? (↘) How many brothers and sisters do you have? (↘) What is most important to you in life? (↘)

3-4. Answers depend on your interview.

5. a) Sophomore, Junior, Senior. b) Associate's degree, Bachelor's degree, Master's degree. c) 1 dormitory, 2 semester, 3 scholarship, 4 major, 5 specialize, 6 graduation. d) 1 declare a major, 2 undergraduate, 3 graduate, 4 program.

6. 1 design, 2 design, 3 volunteered, 4 volunteer, 5 challenge, 6 challenges, 7 mentor, 8 mentor.

7. a) inspire and motivate; pursue; develop. b) 1 inspired / motivated, 2 pursue, 3 developed.

8. 1 employer, 2 adventure, 3 travel, 4 goal, in high demand, 5 skills.

9. 1 recipient, 2 opportunity, 3 public service, 4 journey, 5 task, 6 resource, 7 personal, 8 professional, 9 valuable.

My notes